

Optimal AI — Standard Operating Procedures

1. Client Intake Process

1.1 Inquiry Channels

Channel	Method	Response Time
Website contact form	Email notification	Within 24 hours
AI Chatbot (FAQ)	Automated FAQ + fallback to email	Instant + 24hr
LinkedIn DM	Direct message to @OptimalAI_ZA	Within 12 hours
Email	hello@optimalai.com	Within 24 hours

1.2 Initial Response Template

Subject: Re: [Inquiry] – Free 1-Hour AI Consultation

Hi [Name],

Thanks for reaching out to Optimal AI.

Here's how it works:

1. ****Free 1-hour consultation**** – we hop on a video call to understand your business
2. ****We identify your top AI opportunities**** – no fluff, just a clear roadmap
3. ****You decide whether to proceed**** – zero pressure, no commitment

Would you like to schedule your free session this [week/next week]? I have availability on [day] at [time].

Best,
[Your Name]
Optimal AI

1.3 Qualification Checklist

Before the discovery call, confirm:

- ☐ Business type (SME / Startup / Enterprise)
- ☐ Industry vertical
- ☐ Pain point / reason for reaching out
- ☐ Decision-maker status (are they the person who can say yes?)
- ☐ Budget range (SA pricing / International pricing)

2. Discovery Call Structure (Free 1-Hour)

2.1 Agenda

Segment	Duration	Purpose
Introduction & rapport	5 min	Build trust, set expectations
Business context	10 min	Understand their business model, size, industry
Pain point exploration	15 min	Identify manual processes, bottlenecks, frustrations
Opportunity mapping	15 min	Match AI solutions to their specific needs
ROI estimation	10 min	Quantify cost savings & efficiency gains
Next steps	5 min	Present options, no-pressure close

2.2 Discovery Questions to Ask

1. "What are the top 3 tasks your team spends the most time on each week?"
2. "Which of those tasks do you wish could be automated?"
3. "What's the biggest bottleneck in your current workflow?"
4. "Have you tried any AI tools before? What worked or didn't?"
5. "What would it mean for your business if you could save 20 hours/week?"
6. "Who else would be involved in a decision to implement AI?"
7. "What budget range are you considering for this?"

2.3 Call Outcome Options

- **Fit confirmed:** Send proposal within 24 hours
- **Needs more thought:** Send summary + offer to reconnect in 2 weeks
- **Not a fit:** Recommend resources / point them in right direction (leave a positive impression)

3. Proposal & Pricing

3.1 Proposal Structure

1. **Summary** — 2-3 sentences restating their problem and your solution
2. **Identified Opportunities** — Bullet list of AI applications with estimated impact
3. **Recommended Package** — Which service(s) fit their needs
4. **Pricing** — SA market or International, one-time or subscription
5. **Timeline** — Estimated delivery dates
6. **Next Steps** — What happens after they say yes

3.2 Pricing Reference

Service	SA Market (ZAR)	International (USD)
AI Strategy (Free Consult)	Free	Free
AI Chatbot	R 7,500 – R 25,000	\$500 – \$2,500
Process Automation	R 15,000 – R 50,000	\$1,500 – \$5,000
AI Analytics	R 10,000 – R 35,000	\$1,000 – \$3,500
Content Engine	R 5,000 – R 20,000/mo	\$500 – \$2,000/mo

Full Integration	R 50,000 – R 150,000	\$5,000 – \$15,000
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4. Project Delivery Pipeline

4.1 Stages

Inquiry → Discovery Call → Proposal Signed → Kickoff → Build → Review → Deploy → Handoff → Support

4.2 Stage Details

Kickoff (Day 1)

- Welcome email with project timeline
- Access to data / systems needed
- Set up communication channel (WhatsApp/Slack)
- Share project tracker

Build (Days 2-8)

- AI solution development
- Weekly progress updates (minimum)
- Client review at 50% and 90% complete

Review (Day 5-9)

- Client reviews working prototype
- Feedback collected and incorporated
- Maximum 2 revision rounds (unless unlimited in package)

Deploy (Day 6-10)

- Production deployment
- Documentation delivered
- Team training session (if included)

Handoff & Support

- 1-month email support (Growth)
- 3-month priority support (Professional)
- 6-month dedicated support (Enterprise)

4.3 Communication Cadence

Package	Updates	Review Points	Support
Growth	Weekly	1 revision	Email, 1 month
Professional	Twice weekly	Unlimited revisions	Priority, 3 months
Enterprise	Daily	Unlimited revisions	Dedicated, 6 months

5. Quality Control Checklist

5.1 Pre-Delivery Checklist

- ☐ All features from scope are implemented and working
- ☐ Client data is secure and properly handled
- ☐ Error states are handled gracefully
- ☐ Performance is acceptable (load time < 2s)
- ☐ Mobile responsive (if applicable)
- ☐ Documentation is complete and understandable
- ☐ Client has been trained (if applicable)
- ☐ Testimonial requested

5.2 Post-Delivery Checklist

- ☐ Client confirmed satisfaction
- ☐ Invoice sent
- ☐ Case study notes taken (for marketing)
- ☐ Referral requested
- ☐ Follow-up scheduled (2 weeks, 1 month, 3 months)

6. Referral System

6.1 Requesting Referrals

Timing: After successful delivery + positive client feedback

Template:

"Thanks again for the opportunity to work together. If you know any other businesses that could benefit from AI automation, I'd love an introduction. I'll give you [discount/reward] for every referral that turns into a project."

6.2 Referral Incentive

- Referrer:** 10% of first project value as discount on their next project OR cash
- Referee:** 5% discount on first project

7. Tools & Infrastructure

Tool	Purpose	Cost
Cloudflare Pages	Website hosting	Free
optimalai.com	Domain	~\$12/year
Zoho Mail / Cloudflare Email Routing	Professional email	Free
Calendly (free)	Scheduling consultations	Free
Google Meet / Zoom (free)	Video consultations	Free
Claude / ChatGPT	AI development	\$20/mo

Notion	Project management	Free
LinkedIn (free)	Marketing & outreach	Free

8. Financial Systems

8.1 Invoicing

- Use Google Sheets + PDF invoice template (free)
- Payment terms: 50% upfront, 50% on delivery
- SA clients: EFT / PayFast
- International: Wise / PayPal

8.2 Record Keeping

- Client folder: proposal → contract → deliverables → handoff docs
 - Financial log: invoice date, amount, payment received, outstanding
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9. Continuous Improvement

- After each project: document lessons learned
- Update FAQ database with new questions from client interactions
- Review and update pricing quarterly
- Collect testimonials after every successful delivery
- Track lead sources to focus on highest-performing channels